

Parent Step-By-Step Guide: Card, Bank, And Autopay Payments

Last updated: September 2, 2026

Audience: parents and guardians paying tuition through The BEE Suite.

CURRENT GUIDE Confirm the correct school and an approved feature before following these steps.

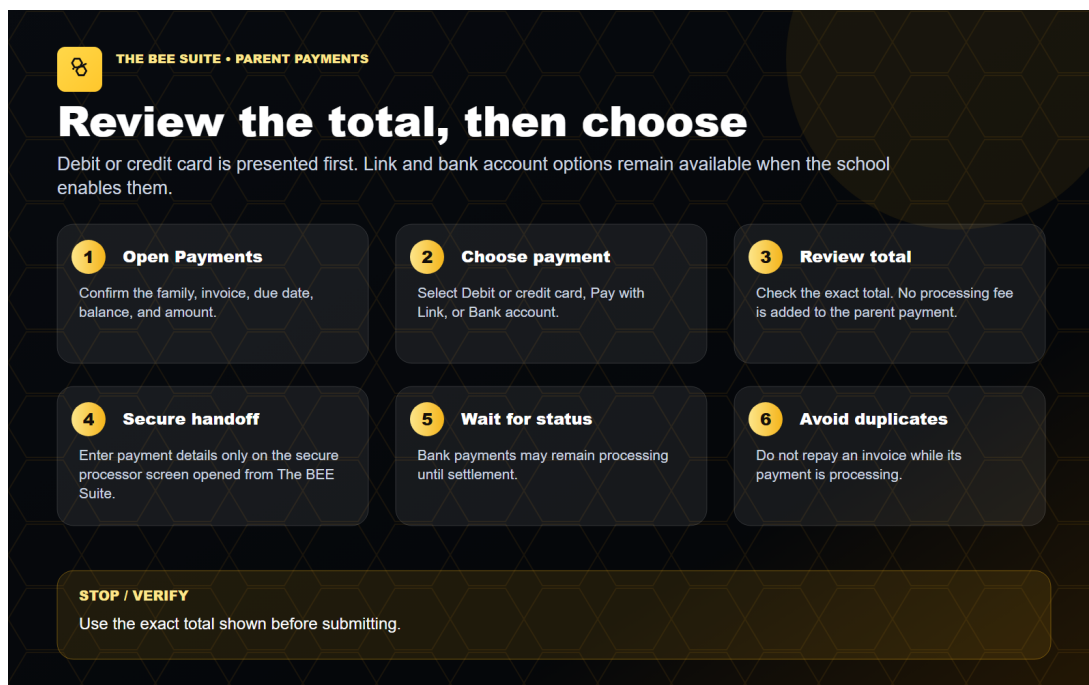
Goal

Choose the payment method that works for your family. The current portal presents debit or credit card first, followed by bank account options when the school enables them. The school absorbs Stripe processing costs, so no processing fee is added to the parent payment. The exact total is shown before submission.

Exact totals are always shown before you submit payment. Do not submit a payment if the amount or payment method looks wrong.

Visual Preview

Figure: Parent payment choices



Where You May Start

You may see the bank verification flow from either place:

- Parent portal payment area: open the Parent Portal and go to Payments.
- Secure payment setup link: open the branded The BEE Suite link your school sent by email or portal notification.

Both paths use a secure Stripe handoff. The BEE Suite does not store your bank login, full bank account number, or full card number.

Pay Or Save A Debit Or Credit Card

Card is presented first in the current parent payment flow.

1. Open the parent portal or the secure payment request from your school.
2. Choose **Save card** to save a method, or **Debit** or **credit card** to pay an open invoice.
3. Review the family, invoice, amount, payment method, and exact total. No processing fee is added to the parent payment.
4. Continue to Stripe's secure card form.
5. Enter the card details there, not in a BEE Suite message, email, note, or screenshot.
6. Submit and wait for the confirmation screen.
7. Return to the portal and confirm the saved method, payment, receipt, or invoice status.

Connect A Bank Account

Use this when you want to set up ACH/bank payment or autopay.

1. Open the parent portal or the secure payment setup link from your school.
2. Choose **Connect bank account**.
3. Continue to the secure bank verification screen.
4. Search for your bank.
5. Log in through the secure bank portal.
6. Choose the checking account you want to use.
7. Confirm the account.
8. Return to The BEE Suite.
9. Wait for the confirmation that payment information was submitted.
10. Check that the saved method or autopay status updates in the portal.

If the status says pending, do not repeat setup unless the school says the first attempt failed.

Pay An Open Invoice By Bank

Use this when a tuition invoice is due today.

1. Open the parent portal.
2. Go to **Payments**.
3. Review the invoice number, due date, and amount.
4. Choose **Bank account** when available.
5. Enter the requested details in the secure bank payment form.
6. Confirm the bank account and payment amount.
7. Submit the payment.
8. Wait for the confirmation screen.
9. Return to the parent portal.
10. If the payment shows as processing, wait for the school ledger to update after reconciliation.

Bank payments can take a few business days to fully settle. Do not submit the same invoice again while a bank payment is processing.

Pay An Open Invoice By ACH

If your portal shows Bank account, use it when you want to make a bank payment without saving a new card.

1. Open Payments.
2. Review the invoice.
3. Choose Bank account.
4. Follow the secure bank account instructions.
5. Confirm the amount before submitting.
6. Wait for the confirmation screen.

When To Use A Card

Use Debit or credit card when that is the payment method you prefer. The school absorbs Stripe processing costs, so no processing fee is added to the parent payment.

Autopay Status Meanings

Status	Meaning	What to do
Enabled	A payment method is saved and autopay is active if your school uses autopay	Watch invoices and receipts
Pending	Bank verification or payment method setup is not fully complete	Wait or contact the school if it does not update
Disabled	No active autopay method is saved	Choose Save card, Connect bank account, or ask the school for a secure payment request

Safety Rules

- Start from <https://thebeesuite.io/parents> or a branded The BEE Suite link sent by your school.
- Do not send bank details, card numbers, or passwords by text, email, message, or screenshot.
- Do not pay the same invoice twice if a payment is pending.
- Contact the school if the family, child, invoice, or amount looks wrong.

Troubleshooting

Contact the school if:

- Your bank cannot be verified.
- Setup says pending for more than a few business days.
- Your invoice still looks unpaid after a confirmed payment.
- You chose the wrong payment method.
- The checkout adds a processing, convenience, service, platform, or application fee to your payment.
- You see a family or invoice that is not yours.

Include your name, child name, school, invoice number, payment method, time of attempt, and a screenshot if safe to share.